

Conversation

#21

CONVERSATION

TRAVEL PLANS & UNEXPECTED PROBLEMS – WHEN THINGS DON'T GO AS PLANNED

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 8 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **travel language, problem-solving, emotional control, and decision-making.**

It's **Saturday morning** in **São Paulo**.

A group of friends planned a **short weekend trip** to relax and disconnect from the city.

Everything seemed organized — transportation, lodging, schedule.

But just before leaving, **unexpected problems appear**.

Time is limited, money is involved, and frustration is rising.

The group must decide quickly whether to **continue, adapt, or cancel the trip**.

Travel Plan Overview

Item	Plan
Destination	Campos do Jordão
Transportation	1 car + 1 rented car
Departure time	8:00 a.m.
Return	Sunday evening
Accommodation	Airbnb (2 nights)
Budget per person	R\$ 550

Student Coaching – How to Use the Information

- React emotionally but realistically
- Defend your position using **time, money, comfort, or safety**
- Suggest alternatives (delay, change destination, cancel)
- Accept that **not everyone will be happy**

Characters

1. Alex – The Organizer

"I spent time planning this trip. Routes, timing, reservations — everything was checked. Now things are falling apart, and it's frustrating. I don't want all this effort to go to waste. I'm pushing to make it work."

2. Rachel – The Anxious One

“I don’t like surprises when traveling. If things start going wrong, I get stressed fast. Delays, money issues, uncertainty — that ruins the experience. I’d rather cancel than travel stressed.
I need reassurance.”

3. Mike – The Easygoing Friend

“Trips don’t need to be perfect. Problems happen — that’s part of it. I’m okay adapting or changing plans. What matters is being together. I don’t want drama.”

4. Emily – The Comfort-Focused Friend

“I care about where we sleep and how we get there. If comfort drops too much, the trip isn’t worth it. Long delays and bad conditions stress me out. I don’t want to ‘survive’ a weekend. I want a pleasant experience.”

5. Kevin – The Budget-Sensitive Friend

“I planned my money carefully for this trip. Extra costs make me uncomfortable. If prices go up, I need to rethink everything. I don’t want to be pressured financially. I need transparency.”

6. Laura – The Adventure Lover

“Unexpected things don’t scare me — they excite me. This could become a better story than the original plan. Changing the destination or schedule is fine. I want movement, not hesitation. Let’s improvise.”

7. Daniel – The Practical One

“I look at facts. Traffic, weather, costs — emotions won’t change those. If the plan doesn’t make sense anymore, we should stop. Forcing it is a mistake. I want a logical decision.”

8. Olivia – The Mediator

“Everyone is reacting differently, and that’s normal. But we need one decision, not eight opinions. Someone will have to compromise. Dragging this out makes it worse. I’ll help the group decide.”

Full name: _____

Theme: Dealing with Unexpected Problems While Traveling

Guide your writing:

- 1 Describe the travel plan and what went wrong.
- 2 Explain how people reacted emotionally.
- 3 Describe the final decision.
- 4 End with one lesson about flexibility or planning.

Length: 120–150 words

Tone: personal and reflective

Title:

[illegible]